

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in property law, case file management, client communication and document preparation at BCLP, Citizens Advice East Berkshire and Q-Legal. Completed a dedicated Real Estate Disputes rotation at BCLP covering landlord and tenant matters, easements, rights of light and leasehold issues, with responsibility for hearing bundles, legal research and matter records across concurrent files. Currently advising clients on housing matters at Citizens Advice, managing files from instruction through to submission. Organised, client-focused and comfortable handling volume work to deadline.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules covering dispute resolution, procedural law, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module: 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Advanced Contract Law, Company Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients on housing matters alongside employment, welfare benefits, debt and family issues; takes detailed factual statements and establishes chronologies
- Manages files from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules and applications, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Identifies legal and evidential issues, researches complex points and advises clients on procedural requirements and available options
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for clients under pressure, including in housing situations requiring urgent action

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Worked across landlord and tenant disputes, rights of light, easements and leasehold matters; conducted legal and factual research on property law issues
- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Maintained matter records in iManage; managed document-heavy files across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Prepared client notes and supported fee earners throughout the litigation process

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial; conducted legal research
- Became the only junior on the team before a significant deadline; coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the advice deadline; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused guidance

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; document review and analysis; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, matter file organisation, procedural histories, deadline tracking, concurrent file management across multiple matters